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54TH EID AL ETIHAD CELEBRATIONS LIGHT UP NATION

The Sharjah Museums Authority marked UAE's 54th Eid Al Etihad with special activities and community events as celebrations swept across the nation with vibrant displays of joy, pride and national unity. Government buildings, public spaces and shopping centres glowed with UAE flags and festive décor, fostering a sense of patriotism across all emirates. The celebrations reflect the nation's remarkable achievements, its humanitarian values, and its standing as a model of progress, inspiring residents and visitors alike.

SEE ALSO P2-4, 6, 8-9

UAE allocates \$1b to support Yemen's energy sector

Move reflects efforts to advance sustainable development in Yemen

ABU DHABI

Following the directives of President His Highness Sheikh Mohamed Bin Zayed Al Nahyan, with the close follow-up by Sheikh Mansour Bin Zayed Al Nahyan, Vice-President, Deputy Prime Minister

and Chairman of the Presidential Court, the UAE announced a commitment of \$1 billion to support the development of the energy sector in Yemen.

This initiative aligns with the UAE's continuous efforts to advance sustainable development in Yemen, reflecting its steadfast commitment to providing a dignified life for the brotherly people of Yemen.

The announcement was made during the UAE's participation

in the first Yemen National Energy Conference (YFNEC 2025), where Mohamed Hamad Al Zaabi, UAE Ambassador to the Republic of Yemen, participated.

He affirmed the UAE's commitment to advancing the development of the sustainable energy sector and addressing the existing challenges, in addition to strengthening constructive partnerships between the public and private sectors and exploring future investment op-

portunities in Yemen. For his part, Salem Bin Braik, Prime Minister of Yemen, commended the long-standing bilateral ties, and the UAE's continuous support for the Yemeni people's aspirations toward growth, development, and stability.

The event witnessed broad international participation, including permanent member states of the UN and representatives from the Office of the UN Envoy to Yemen.

— WAM

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Samantha Ruth Prabhu ties the knot with Raj Nidimoru

Intimate wedding sparks social media frenzy

DUBAI

BY MANJUSHA

RADHAKRISHNAN

Entertainment, Lifestyle and Sport Editor



Samantha Ruth Prabhu and filmmaker Raj Nidimoru have stepped into a new chapter of their lives, choosing to marry in an intimate, quietly elegant ceremony at Sadhguru's Isha Foundation in Coimbatore yesterday. In a move refreshingly un-Bollywood, the couple kept the affair spiritual, simple and limited to close family and a handful of friends.

The first pictures online show Samantha in a deep-red bridal ensemble rooted in South Indian tradition, styled with gold jewels. Raj complements her in an ivory bandhgala, setting the tone for a ceremony defined by calm rather than spectacle.

Both arrive at this moment after weathering their own fractured personal histories. Samantha, one of South India's most bankable actresses, was previously married to actor Naga

Chaitanya before their highly publicised separation in 2021. Raj Nidimoru, one half of the celebrated Raj & DK duo, has also had his share of personal transitions. Their choice of Isha, a space associated with reflection and inner stillness, feels intentional — a quiet reset rather than a grand production.

As soon as the pictures went up, actresses including Parvathy Thiruvothu, Nimrit Kaur Ahluwalia and others flooded her timeline with congratulatory messages, signalling warm industry support for this new beginning.

The images radiate serenity and renewal — two individuals choosing intention, grace and companionship as they start afresh.

SEE ALSO P15

UAE rushes aid to flood-hit Sri Lankans

GESTURE COMES AS DEADLY FLOODING TOLL ACROSS ASIA CLIMBS PAST 1,100

DUBAI

BY STEPHEN N. R.

Senior Associate Editor

As per the directives of President His Highness Sheikh Mohamed Bin Zayed Al Nahyan, the UAE has launched an urgent humanitarian response to assist communities devastated by the severe floods and landslides sweeping across Sri Lanka.

Acting through the Joint Operations Command, the UAE Aid Agency and the UAE Red Crescent, the country has deployed specialised search and rescue teams from the Abu Dhabi Civil Defence Authority to bolster ongoing operations in the worst-affected regions.

The response also includes the rapid delivery of emergency relief supplies, comprising essential food items, medical provisions, and critical shelter materials for displaced families.

Relief and shelter supplies

The UAE will continue dispatching additional relief and shelter supplies to support the people of Sri Lanka, ease their suffering, and help accelerate recovery and stabilisation efforts in the aftermath of the disaster.

The UAE gesture comes as the toll from deadly flooding and landslides across Asia climbed past 1,100 yesterday, with Sri Lanka among the hardest-hit.

Prolonged, intense rainfall

The response also includes the rapid delivery of emergency relief supplies, comprising essential food items, medical provisions, and critical shelter materials for displaced families.

triggered Cyclone Ditwah-linked floods and landslides that have killed at least 355 people, with another 366 missing, prompting the government to declare a state of emergency and call for international aid. Military helicopters have been deployed to rescue stranded residents and deliver food, though one crashed north of Colombo on Sunday, killing the pilot.

Floodwaters in the capital peaked overnight before beginning to recede, but officials warn the full scale of devastation — particularly in the worst-hit central districts — is only now becoming clear as blocked roads are cleared. President Anura Kumara Dissanayake has called it the largest and most challenging natural disaster in Sri Lanka's history.

Separate weather systems unleashed torrential, prolonged rainfall across Sri Lanka, Indonesia's Sumatra, southern Thailand and northern Malaysia last week.

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